

22 Days to the Exam

Day 1 = Mon 5 Oct 2026 · Day 22 = Mon 26 Oct · CBT-I on Tue 27 & Wed 28 Oct

Your own date and shift: city intimation slip ($\approx$ 17 Oct) and admit card ($\approx$ 23 Oct) — dates as reported; check the official RRB site.

What changed from v1, and why

- **General Science is 30 questions, not 15.** v1 was wrong — its four sections added up to only 85. Science now gets 110 min a day, the largest block.
- **CBT-I is now 27-28 Oct.** RRB's revised notice of 2 Oct, as reported, dropped 30 Oct. The plan still finishes on 26 Oct.
- **New daily static-GA block (25 min).** About two-thirds of GA questions in the 2026 papers were static, not current affairs (R).
- **Priorities re-ranked** into S / A / B / C from PYQ evidence. Added: chain rule, consecutive numbers, weekday scheduling, matter & mixtures, cell organelles, food production & agriculture. Syllogism and Venn diagrams cut to one 20-min pattern session.
- **Chemistry and biology re-sequenced** on Days 9–18 to follow question frequency.
- **No fixed 60-second rule.** Pace is set per section. The paper averages **54 sec a question** ($90 \text{ min} \div 100$), not 90 sec as v1 said.
- **Mock analysis is 60-90 min**, not 45. **Target: 75+ net.**

Evidence key — used in every priority table

O = official CEN 04/2026 (pattern, syllabus) · **Y** = your 12-paper audit (6 RRB JE Dec 2024 + 6 Feb 2026 JE/DMS/CMA papers, reported by you — I haven't seen the papers yet) · **R** = Result Khabar's 2026 seven-paper analysis (numbers as quoted to me; the page is blocked here, so I couldn't check them) · **P** = PracticeMock analysis of the 16 Dec 2024 shift (as quoted; not checked) · **J** = my judgement.

Anything resting only on R, P or J is provisional until I analyse your papers.

1 · Exam facts

Item	Value	Status
Exam	RRB JE / DMS / CMA, CEN 04/2026, CBT-I	Official
Pattern	100 questions in 90 min: Maths 30 · Reasoning 25 · General Awareness 15 · General Science 30	Official (CEN), confirmed by several sites
Negative marking	1/3 mark per wrong answer	Official
Section counts	Indicative — may vary a little	Official (CEN wording)
Science level	Physics, chemistry and life sciences up to Class 10 (CBSE)	Official
Dates	27 & 28 Oct 2026, multiple shifts a day. Revised notice dated 2 Oct; the earlier schedule was 27, 28 and 30 Oct	Reported by several sites — confirm on the RRB site
City slip / admit card	≈ 17 Oct / ≈ 23 Oct	Reported — check
Role of CBT-I	Screening only: the normalised score shortlists you for CBT-II and does not count in the final merit	Reported; same as earlier cycles
Last cycle's cut-offs	Feb 2026 CBT-I (CEN 05/2025), UR: about 65-86 normalised marks depending on RRB and post group (e.g. RRB Mumbai UR 70.6-83.3)	Reported by aggregator sites; I couldn't open the official PDFs

2 · The 75+ score map

Last cycle's reported UR cut-offs (65-86) make 75 a realistic **floor**, not a ceiling. Train for 75+ and use **80** as the safety line in mocks. I'll set your real line once you tell me your RRB and category.

Section	Qs	Correct	Max wrong	Left	Net	Safety 80+: correct / wrong → net
Maths	30	25	1	4	24.67	26 / 1 → 25.67
Reasoning	25	22	1	2	21.67	23 / 1 → 22.67
General Science	30	22	3	5	21.00	24 / 2 → 23.33
General Awareness	15	10	2	3	9.33	10 / 1 → 9.67
Total	100	79	7	14	76.67	83 / 5 → 81.33

The rule

About 79 correct with no more than 7 wrong. Net = correct – wrong ÷ 3. Seven wrong answers cost 2.33 marks; every 3 wrong answers wipe out one correct one.

Science is your biggest lever: 30 questions, recall-based, and the fastest to answer — and the area you're rustiest in.

3-6 · What to study: S / A / B / C

S = must master · **A** = should know · **B** = quick coverage · **C** = skip unless time is left. The evidence column shows how often a topic appears in papers, not whether it is in the syllabus — everything here is inside the official syllabus except probability. The Day column shows where it is scheduled, so you can check that nothing is missing.

Maths (30 questions)

Tier	Topic	Evidence	Day
S	Percentage	P	1
S	Ratio & proportion, partnership	P · R: 3-4 per paper	2
S	Profit, loss & discount	P · R: ≈3 per paper	3
S	Simple & compound interest	P	4
S	Number system	P	5
S	Simplification / BODMAS	P	6 + daily 5-question warm-up
S	LCM & HCF	Y	6
S	Average	P · R: statistics + average 3-4	7
S	Time & work	P	9
S	Time, speed & distance, trains	J	10
S	Mensuration 2D & 3D	R: 2-3 per paper	12, 13
S	Algebra basics	R: 3-4 per paper	14
S	Statistics (mean, median, mode) & DI	Y · P (DI) · R	12, 18
A	Ages	Y	7
A	Pipes & cisterns · boats & streams	J (built on time & work, TSD)	9, 10
A	Mixture & alligation · chain rule	J · Y (chain rule)	11
A	Consecutive-number problems	Y	14
A	Geometry	J	16
A	Trigonometry, heights & distances	P	17
B	Calendar & clock	Y: don't over-invest	18
B	Probability basics (not named in the CEN list)	P: appeared in a 2024 shift	18
C	Long DI sets · rare geometry theorems	J	—

Reasoning (25 questions)

Tier	Topic	Evidence	Day
S	Number series	R: series $\approx$ 5 per paper (with alphabet)	1
S	Alphabet & alphanumeric series	R	2
S	Analogy	R: $\approx$ 5 per paper	3
S	Classification (odd one out)	J	4
S	Coding-decoding	R: $\approx$ 2 per paper	5
S	Blood relations	R: $\approx$ 2 per paper	6
S	Direction sense	J	7
S	Order & ranking, dictionary order	J	9
S	Mathematical operations, missing numbers	J	10
S	Weekday scheduling, floor / box arrangements	Y · R: analytical 4-5 per paper	11
A	Seating arrangement (linear, circular)	R (part of analytical)	13
A	Mixed puzzles	R	14
A	Statement-conclusion / assumption	J	12
A	Mirror & water images, paper folding, embedded figures	J	16
A	Figure counting, dice & cubes	J	17
B	Syllogism & Venn — one 20-min pattern session only	Y: low · P: 4-5 syllogism Qs in one Dec 2024 shift	11
B	Data sufficiency	J	12
B	Word formation, decision making, calendar & clock	Y: low · J	18
C	Input-output · long multi-variable puzzles in the exam	Y: don't over-invest	—

General Science (30 questions)

R counted 210 science questions across 7 papers from 2026: chemistry 81, physics 66, biology 63. Those counts drive this table.

Tier	Topic	Evidence (R: Qs of 210)	Day
S	Motion, force & Newton's laws, work, energy, power, gravitation	R: 24	1-3
S	Light: mirrors, lenses, human eye & its defects	R: 23 · Y (eye defects)	6
S	Atoms, molecules, chemical formulae	R: 22	9
S	Food production & agriculture (crops, manures, fertilisers, animal husbandry)	R: 20 · Y	14
S	Electricity & magnetism	R: 18	7
S	Cell, cell organelles, tissues	R: 18 · Y	13
S	Chemical reactions & equations	R: 15	10
S	Acids, bases, salts, everyday chemistry	R: 15	10, 12
A	Metals & non-metals, alloys (+ periodic table, bonding)	R: 13	11

Tier	Topic	Evidence (R: Qs of 210)	Day
A	Human physiology / life processes	R: 11	16
A	Environment & ecology	R: 9	17
A	Carbon compounds & fuels	R: 8	12
A	Matter, states, mixtures & separation	R: 8 · Y	9
B	Health, diseases, pathogens, vitamins	R: 5	14, 18
B	Plant hormones, heredity, evolution	J (no separate R count)	17
B	Pressure, fluids, heat	J (no separate R count)	4
B	Sound & waves	R: 1	5
C	Derivations · advanced organic chemistry	J	—

Days 1–7 give physics 7 days although chemistry has the larger share. That's why Days 9–12 get the full 110-min science block, and Day 15 adds chemistry revision. On Days 4–5 (B-tier physics), the spare science time goes to S-tier physics PYQs.

General Awareness (15 questions)

R: 68 of 105 GA questions were static or core and 37 were current affairs — roughly 65 : 35. Current affairs alone cannot carry this section.

Tier	Topic	Evidence	Day
S	Current affairs, last 6–8 months: schemes, appointments, awards, sports, science, tech & defence, reports & rankings, important days	O · R: ≈35%	Daily, 20 MCQs
S	Polity & constitution basics	O · J	1, 2, 9
S	Modern history & the freedom movement	O · Y	3, 4
S	Geography: physical & Indian	O · Y	5, 6, 10
S	Indian economy basics	O · Y	7, 11
A	Culture: dances, festivals, books & authors	J	12
A	Sports & awards (static part)	O · J	13
A	Indian Railways facts, zones & HQs · organisations & their HQs	J	14
A	Environment, national parks, biosphere reserves	O	10, 16
A	Science & tech in the news (ISRO, defence)	O	18
B	Ancient & medieval history — famous facts only	J	17
C	Obscure GK · reading newspapers cover to cover	J	—

Do not waste time on

- Reading full history or polity textbooks — do topic PYQs instead.
- Long DI sets, input-output, derivations, advanced organic chemistry.
- A new course, book or app. You already have your maths book, Testbook and these PDFs.
- Random question banks before the PYQs on the same topic.

7 · Corrected 22-day calendar

Day	Date	Maths	Reasoning	Science (110 min)	Static GA (25 min)
1	Mon 5 Oct	Percentage	Number series	Physics: units, measurement, motion	Polity 1: Constitution making, Preamble, Parts & Schedules
2	Tue 6 Oct	Ratio & proportion, partnership	Alphabet series	Physics: force & laws of motion	Polity 2: Fundamental Rights, DPSP, Duties
3	Wed 7 Oct	Profit, loss & discount	Analogy	Physics: work, energy, power, gravitation	Modern history 1: 1857-1905
4	Thu 8 Oct	Simple & compound interest	Classification	Physics: pressure, fluids, heat (B) + S-tier PYQs	Modern history 2: 1905-1947
5	Fri 9 Oct	Number system	Coding-decoding	Physics: waves & sound (B) + motion/force PYQs	Physical geography
6	Sat 10 Oct	LCM & HCF, simplification, surds	Blood relations	Physics: light (S)	Indian geography 1: rivers, mountains, soils, climate
7	Sun 11 Oct	Average + ages	Direction sense	Physics: electricity & magnetism (S)	Economy 1: GDP, inflation, RBI, budget, GST
8	Mon 12 Oct	FULL MOCK 1 + analysis (60-90 min)	(in mock)	Physics revision: S-tier PYQs + mistake log	CA: last month re-test
9	Tue 13 Oct	Time & work, pipes & cisterns	Order & ranking, dictionary order	Chemistry: matter & mixtures, atoms, molecules, formulae	Polity 3: President, Parliament, judiciary, amendments
10	Wed 14 Oct	TSD, trains, boats & streams	Mathematical operations, missing numbers	Chemistry: chemical reactions; acids, bases & salts	Indian geography 2: national parks, dams, minerals
11	Thu 15 Oct	Mixture & alligation, chain rule	Weekday scheduling, floor/box puzzles + 20 min syllogism/Venn	Chemistry: metals & non-metals, periodic table, bonding, alloys	Economy 2: banking, NITI Aayog, schemes
12	Fri 16 Oct	Mensuration 2D + statistics	Statement-conclusion, data sufficiency	Chemistry: carbon compounds, fuels, everyday chemistry	Culture: dances, festivals, books & authors
13	Sat 17 Oct	Mensuration 3D	Seating arrangement	Biology: cell, organelles, tissues	Sports & awards (static) · check city slip
14	Sun 18 Oct	Algebra + consecutive numbers	Mixed puzzles	Biology: food production & agriculture; nutrition, vitamins	Indian Railways · organisations & HQs
15	Mon 19 Oct	FULL MOCK 2 + analysis	(in mock)	Chemistry revision: S-tier PYQs	CA: last 2 months re-test

Day	Date	Maths	Reasoning	Science (110 min)	Static GA (25 min)
16	Tue 20 Oct	Geometry	Mirror/water images, paper folding, embedded figures	Biology: human physiology (life processes)	Environment, national parks, biosphere reserves
17	Wed 21 Oct	Trigonometry, heights & distances	Figure counting, dice & cubes	Biology: plants & hormones, heredity, evolution, ecology	Ancient & medieval history (B)
18	Thu 22 Oct	DI + probability basics + calendar & clock	Word formation, decision making	Biology: health, diseases, microbes + biology PYQs	Science & tech in news; reports & rankings
19	Fri 23 Oct	FULL MOCK 3 + analysis	Weak-topic drill	Science traps: physics + chemistry	Static GA mixed PYQs · download admit card
20	Sat 24 Oct	FULL MOCK 4 + analysis	Weak-topic drill	Science traps: biology	CA: months 3–6 recap
21	Sun 25 Oct	FULL MOCK 5 + analysis	Weak-topic drill	S-tier science one-pagers	CA: last 2 months recap
22	Mon 26 Oct	Formula sheet	Mistake log	S-tier one-pagers	GA fact list · sleep by 10:30 pm

Days 1–7 are built (Day01–Day07_Plan.pdf). Days 8–22 will be built in the same format — ideally after I've analysed your 12 papers. If weekends are freer, swap Day 7 ↔ Day 8 and Day 14 ↔ Day 15 so mocks fall on Sundays.

8 · Daily hours by subject

Standard study day — about 5½ hours with breaks

Block	Time	What you do
0 · Recall	15 min	Yesterday's 10 questions + redo yesterday's mistakes. First thing, every day.
1 · Maths	75 min	5 simplification questions (speed) → formulas & patterns (10) → 2–3 book questions per pattern, timed → 10 Testbook PYQs on the topic → log
2 · Reasoning	45 min	Method (10) → 15 timed questions, PYQs first → log
3 · Science	110 min	Lessons + quick checks (≈60) → 20-question practice set (20) → 15–20 Testbook PYQs on the topic (25) → log
4 · General awareness	45 min	20 current-affairs MCQs (20) → static topic of the day: PYQs on it (25)
5 · Close	15 min	Redo today's wrong questions · 3 rules for tomorrow · send me your scores
Breaks	30 min	3 × 10 min, away from the screen

Short day — about 3¾ hours

Recall 10 · Maths 55 · Reasoning 35 · Science 80 · GA 25 · Close 10, plus breaks. Cut in this order: Testbook science PYQs → reasoning down to 10 questions → static GA down to 10 min.

Never cut recall, maths or the science lessons. Two short days in a row → tell me and I'll re-plan.

Mock day (Days 8, 15, 19–21) — about 5 hours

Block	Time	What you do
Mock	90 min	One sitting, exam mode, no pausing, no phone. Same time of day as your likely shift if you can.
Analysis	60–90 min	Template in section 11. Not optional — a mock without analysis is mostly wasted.
Redo	30 min	Every wrong and skipped question, untimed
Revision block	60 min	As in the calendar (physics / chemistry / science traps / weak-topic drill)
Current affairs	20 min	20 MCQs

Non-negotiables

Recall first thing · timed practice (never untimed) · PYQs on every topic you study · mistake log every night · 5 mocks with full analysis · send me your scores every evening · 7 hours' sleep, especially on Days 20–22.

9 · What to do with Testbook

Use	How	When
Topic PYQs	After each maths, reasoning and science topic: RRB JE PYQs on that topic first. If fewer than ≈15, add NTPC / ALP / Group D / Technician questions on the same topic.	Blocks 1–3, daily
GA PYQs	GA PYQs on the static topic of the day	Block 4, daily

Use	How	When
Full mocks	Full RRB JE CBT-I previous papers you haven't attempted — 2026 shifts first, then Dec 2024 — in exam mode. Keep at least 5 unseen. If you've used them all, take Testbook's full mocks.	Days 8, 15, 19–21
Don't	Video courses, live classes, untargeted chapter tests, C-tier topics	—

10 · How to use me (Claude) each day

When	Send me	You get back
Every evening (5 min)	Scores: Maths x/y, Reasoning x/y, Science practice x/20, PYQs x/y, CA x/20 — plus your wrong questions (photo or typed)	The mistake type for each (concept / formula / calculation / misread / careless / memory), the fix, and a 5-question re-test. Repeat mistakes get a rule and a mini-drill.
Stuck on a lesson	The lesson number and what's unclear	A short explanation + 2 check questions
After a mock	The section table (section 11) + your wrong and skipped questions	A mock report and the next day's drill
Once, as soon as possible	Your 12 PYQ papers (PDF)	Topic and question-pattern frequencies, traps, a must-do PYQ bank — and Days 8–22 built from it

11 · Mock analysis template

Section	Attempted	Correct	Wrong	Left	Net	Time (min)	Target net
Maths							24.67
Reasoning							21.67
General Science							21.00
General Awareness							9.33
Total						90	76.67
Step	What to do						
1	Fill the table. Net = correct – wrong ÷ 3.						
2	Tag every wrong answer: concept / formula / calculation / misread / careless / guessed .						
3	Solve every skipped question now, untimed. Solved in under 90 sec? Then you knew it — that's a selection or speed loss , and usually the most valuable list.						
4	Which section overran its time budget (section 12)?						
5	The 3 topics that cost the most marks → tomorrow's weak-topic drill.						
6	Pick 5 questions to redo in 3 days. I'll generate 5 similar ones for your next drill.						
7	Send me the table + wrong and skipped questions.						

12 · Exam strategy (practise it in every mock)

Rule	Detail
Pace	Average: 54 sec a question (90 min ÷ 100). Starting budget: GA ≈8 min · Science ≈22 · Reasoning ≈22 · Maths ≈32 · review ≈6 . This is my inference — adjust it with your mock data.
Order	Suggested: GA → Science → Reasoning → Maths. GA and science are recall — you know it or you don't — so they bank marks fast and leave the longest stretch for calculation. Try it in Mocks 1–2 and keep whichever order gives the higher net.

Rule	Detail
Round 1	Take every question where you see the way at once: facts you know, one-step reasoning, short arithmetic.
Time sinks	GA and science: can't recall it → eliminate and decide, or skip, immediately; thinking longer rarely brings a fact back. Reasoning: no pattern in ≈ 40 sec → mark it and move on. Maths: no method after reading → skip; method clear but calculation long → round 2.
Round 2	Return to marked questions, most promising first. Attempt a puzzle set only if it is clearly solvable.
Guessing	A blind guess has zero expected value ($\frac{1}{4} - \frac{3}{4} \times \frac{1}{3} = 0$) — it only adds risk. Eliminate 1 option → $+1/9$ mark; eliminate 2 → $+1/3$. Guess only after eliminating at least one option, preferably two.
Accuracy	Your budget is ≈ 7 wrong in the whole paper. If a mock goes past that, fix question selection before speed.

13 · Final 48 hours

When	Do	Don't
Day 21 · Sun 25 Oct	Mock 5 + analysis · current affairs, last 2 months · S-tier science one-pagers	Start any new topic
Day 22 · Mon 26 Oct	Formula sheet (60 min) · mistake log (45) · S-tier science summaries (60) · GA fact list (30) · check admit card, centre, route and ID · sleep by 10:30 pm	Full mock · new material · late night
If your shift is 28 Oct	27 Oct = a second light day: mistake log + formulas + one 25-question sectional	Full mock
Exam morning	20 min: formula sheet + your top-10 traps · reach the centre early	Last-minute new facts

What I need from you

#	Item	Why it matters
1	The 12 PYQ papers you audited (PDFs)	The most valuable input: pattern-level analysis, then Days 8–22 built from it
2	Your RRB (zone), category and post preference	Cut-offs varied ≈ 65 –86 by RRB and post group last cycle — this sets your real target
3	Hours available on weekdays and weekends	To confirm the 5½-hour day fits; if not, you use the short day
4	Name of your monthly CA PDF and your maths book	So the daily blocks point to exact sections and exercises
5	Every evening: your scores and wrong questions	The mistake log drives every revision session